

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

What you need -> By when -> Why it matters -> One ask — stop

START HERE

Before making any request, answer: what specifically do I need, and by when? State those two things. Leave out the rest.

SAY THIS

Clean Request Core	<i>"I need X from you by Thursday at 5 pm."</i>
Request Follow-Up	<i>"Does that feel doable by then?"</i>
Micro-Requests	<i>"Two minutes of your time before 3?"</i>
Delegation Requests	<i>"I would like you to own this end to end — scope is X, deadline is Friday."</i>
Personal Asks	<i>"It would mean a lot if you could be there on Saturday."</i>

AVOID

- When the relationship is such that a formal request would feel clinical or cold.
- In brainstorming contexts where you want open-ended input rather than a specific deliverable.
- When you genuinely do not know what you need — clarify that first, then make the request.

REMEMBER

The kindest request is the clearest one.